

Herberth Castro

FULL STACK DEVELOPER & PRODUCT LEADER

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www.behance.net/gallery/224453817/Games-Development-Marketing · herberthcastro.com

Twenty-two years building software, from live-service games to enterprise systems.

I lead full-stack product teams and still write production code. Over twenty-two years I've shipped SaaS platforms, live-service games, and creative tools for studios across three continents. I care about taste, velocity, and building systems the user never has to think about.

I bridge creative vision and technical execution, leading projects from concept to launch in remote, multicultural environments.

Key strengths: product vision, architecture design, team mentoring, creative problem solving, and full-stack development.

Experience

Independent Developer / Product Consultant · **Freelance** Oct 2024 – Present · Costa Rica · Remote

- Designing, building, and shipping web products end to end: product, design, engineering, and ops.
- Full-stack developer and solution architect on Región Gamer at my studio, Insert Coin, for The Road Tech. A multi-country event-management platform with gamification; first deployment at MegaCon Costa Rica, May 2026.
- Personal products: Cifra (cifracr.com), now live, and TwinSoulMatch, in active development.
- Client engagement with a UK-based founder building SiyaChange, an ongoing collaboration with equity participation.
- Senior developer / contractor for Technical Toolboxes (technicaltoolboxes.com), a pipeline-industry SaaS platform used by 19 of the top 20 North American pipeline operators.
- Software and product consulting for Costa Rican government institutions, including MINAE and GOAP.
- Deep hands-on work with modern AI tooling (Claude Code, ChatGPT, generative models) integrated into product workflows.

Next.js · TypeScript · React · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Claude Code · OpenAI · AI / LLM integrations

Head of Product / Lead Developer · Vivo Gaming

Nov 2021 – Sep 2024 · Remote

- Led product development for multiple live-gaming platforms (UI, streaming systems, 3D chroma studios, back-office tools).
- Shipped live-gaming products into non-traditional markets including Thailand, China, and India, alongside established markets in Europe and the United States.
- Spearheaded a full facelift of all HTML5 products, modernizing UX and performance.
- Built a web-based analytics tool in React for monitoring streaming KPIs and usage.
- Oversaw cross-functional teams and product roadmaps across several studio locations.

JavaScript · TypeScript · React · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Unreal Engine · RXDB · Figma · Adobe Suite
· AWS · Power BI

Lead / Senior Developer · Avantica / Encora

Aug 2018 – Nov 2021 · Remote

- Served as Lead Developer for ECOM Agro-Industrial (Switzerland), a multinational trading company (coffee, cocoa, cotton) with 40+ offices worldwide — working within international Agile teams on large-scale enterprise applications.
- Led the front-end architecture using Angular, ensuring component reusability, scalability, and performance optimization across multiple projects.
- Collaborated directly with product owners and solution architects to define UI/UX flows and API integrations.
- Designed and implemented the SMS Web and Android application, a global system for collecting and distributing agricultural data between technicians, farmers, and crops in 35+ countries.
- Integrated OData and Web API back-ends for dynamic grid views and large dataset pagination on a C# / .NET Core backend.
- Implemented real-time notifications and offline sync logic using Azure Service Fabric.
- Conducted code reviews, mentoring, and front-end training for new developers.

C# · Azure · Angular · TypeScript · SQL Server · OData · Web API · Azure Service Fabric · Entity Framework · Power BI

Senior Creative Engineer · Tree Interactive

May 2017 – Jul 2018 · Costa Rica

- Developed SteelSeries Aim Master, a 3D web-based FPS game using React, Three.js, and .NET.
- Designed game logic, UI, and reward systems integrated with AWS services.

React · C# · AWS Lambda · TypeScript · Three.js · SQL · PostgreSQL · AWS

Senior Developer · Aim Consulting

Jan 2016 – Apr 2017 · Seattle, WA

- Built LFO Calculator and TDC Bikes apps for the University of Washington and Seattle County.
- Created an Outlook Add-in integrating Pipeline Deals API and SharePoint.
- Developed Sales & Delivery Tracker, an internal project management and cost control tool.

C# · C++ · React · Azure Functions · AWS Lambda · SQL · RabbitMQ · Angular · Azure

Lead Software Developer · Wells Fargo / Intertec

Jun 2014 – Jan 2016 · Costa Rica

- Led the full-cycle development of the Contract Management System for Wells Fargo DSSG — an enterprise web application to track, calculate, and manage lease agreements for 10,000+ ATM sites across the United States.
- Designed and implemented automated rent and contract renewal modules, reducing manual errors and significantly improving process efficiency.
- Created dynamic reports and dashboards using SQL Server Reporting Services (SSRS) and optimized stored procedures for faster data retrieval.
- Coordinated closely with QA teams, business analysts, and stakeholders to ensure deliverables met corporate standards and compliance policies.
- Ensured adherence to financial security and compliance protocols throughout development.

ASP.NET MVC · C# · Entity Framework · SQL Server · JavaScript · jQuery

Senior Software Engineer · BoszDigital / Prodigious

Feb 2013 – Jun 2014 · Costa Rica

- Developed BrandTracker 3 for Leo Burnett / Coca-Cola — a marketing campaign management platform for Coca-Cola and Fanta.
- Implemented web service APIs for campaign analytics and data visualization.

ASP.NET · C# · SQL Server · JavaScript · Web Services · Azure · Entity Framework

Senior Developer · Axelerate / Semdrive

May 2009 – Feb 2013 · Costa Rica

- Developed Bing Maps Mobile Framework for Microsoft (Windows Mobile 6.x).
- Created SEO Report Tool for Microsoft's Skyrocket program.
- Built AWS Web Manager, a tool for scheduling EC2 events (start/stop/restart).

C# · ASP.NET · JavaScript · SQL Server · AWS · AngularJS · Azure

Developer & Game Designer · Fair Play Labs

Nov 2004 – Mar 2009 · Costa Rica

- Designed and developed Game Studio in C#, a proprietary engine for GBA / Nintendo DS.
- Created Ecovolution, an educational RPG promoting environmental awareness.
- Contributed to multiple outsourced game projects for Digital Blue.

C++ · Game Development · GBA · Nintendo DS · C#

Selected projects

Cifra · Independent Product

2025 – Present · cifracr.com

Independent SaaS ERP for independent professionals in Costa Rica. Cifra covers electronic invoicing (compliant with Hacienda v4.4, the CR Ministry of Finance's e-invoicing standard), clients, collections, and finance. Multiple plans and verticals for professionals across different fields, growing practices, clinics, and more. Personal project where I handle product, design, engineering, and ops.

TypeScript · React · Vite · Tailwind · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Monorepo

Región Gamer · Platform / Studio Project

2026 – Present · app.regiongamer.com

Multi-country event-management and gamification platform for gaming conventions across Latin America (Costa Rica, Mexico, Panama, Nicaragua, Dominican Republic). TypeScript monorepo with a Fastify API, a React admin, and a React Native app. Full gamification engine (points, levels, 5 tiers, achievements, quests), HMAC-signed anti-cheat QR system, real-time dashboards, and an event simulator. 365/365 tests passing; stress-tested at 8,873 req/s across 2,000 concurrent connections. Built at Studio Insert Coin for The Road Tech; first deployment at MegaCon Costa Rica, May 2026.

TypeScript · Fastify · React · React Native · Prisma · PostgreSQL · Redis · BullMQ · Expo · Tailwind

SiyaChange · Client Engagement2024 – Present · siyachange.com

Multi-tenant SaaS Change Impact Assessment (CIA) platform. Organizations upload documents (PDF, DOCX, Excel, audio) and an OpenAI-powered copilot generates structured impact assessments across People, Process, Technology, and Data categories. Includes collaboration (comments, action items, audit trails), interactive dashboards shareable with external stakeholders (no login required), role-based access, and Stripe subscriptions. Built for a UK-based founder as an ongoing client engagement with equity participation.

React · TypeScript · Vite · Tailwind · Fastify · Prisma · PostgreSQL · OpenAI · Stripe · Docker

TwinSoulMatch · Personal Product2024 – Present

Personal product, currently in active development. TwinSoulMatch is a spiritual astrology compatibility platform. Analyzes two people's birth data across four classification channels (Twin Flame, Soulmate, Karmic, Past Life) using Western synastry, Ba Zi, numerology, and MBTI.

TypeScript · React · Node.js

Magic Paws · Creative AI2025 · magicpawsmusic.com/en

In this enchanting world, magical animals use love, light, and kindness to help children grow, heal, and learn. With songs, magical stories, and fun adventures, they teach empathy, curiosity, teamwork, and joy — one paw at a time.

ChatGPT · Sora · Veo3 · Suno

Ocean Speak · Game Development2024 – Present · herberthcr.itch.io/ocean-speak

Interactive speech-based underwater web game for children. The demo takes a while to fully load on the first visit.

TypeScript · React · Phaser 3 · Socket.io · Web Speech API

Education	Languages
Software Engineering Cenfotec / Universidad Latina · 2004-2008	SpanishNative
Software Development Specialist Cenfotec · 2002-2004	EnglishAdvanced
Computer Science Universidad de Costa Rica · 2000-2002	

Skills & tools

PROGRAMMING	GAME & CREATIVE TECH	PRODUCT & LEADERSHIP
C#, .NET, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, React Native, Next.js, Node.js, Fastify, Prisma, SQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Angular, Azure, AWS, Claude Code, AI / LLM integrations	Phaser, Three.js, Unreal Engine, Unity, ChatGPT, Sora / Veo3 / Suno, Adobe Suite, DaVinci Resolve	Product Roadmapping, Team Leadership, Agile / Scrum, Jira, Figma, Confluence, Notion